

Response to Reviewers

Executive Summary

Feedback	How we addressed it
(Solution overview) “One solution provided”	Wrote the overview of the other solution
(Recommendation overview) “No recommendations yet”	Wrote the recommendation overview
“Typically Executive summaries don’t need citations as they are meant to be concise summaries in your own words.”	Removed citations

Background

Feedback	How we addressed it
“Change (degree) to °”	Changed any spelled out special characters to the special character itself.
“State of the current science is not clearly defined and I think that some of the paragraphs could be more fleshed out.”	Talked more in depth about the American beech
“No policies are mentioned”	Added current state and federal policies regarding forest management.
“No stakeholders are mentioned. It would be useful to pick a specific conservation organization in New England as this would help substantially with the framing.”	Chose New England Forestry Foundation as our specific stakeholder

Problem Description

Feedback	How we addressed it
“Write the figure captions more like a scientific journal with the captions underneath and explaining everything that is going on. For example, what is the area of each plot in Figs. 1-2?”	Added more detail to the figure descriptions and described plot measures and survey area
“Stakeholder seems unclear as it seems to be overarching industries. I would try to be a little more specific in mention of stakeholders and values”	Specified and deepened consideration of stakeholder values across local residents, researchers, and conservationists
“Need more consequences for the stakeholder groups”	Outlined status quo considerations for each stakeholder specifically

Solution Description

Feedback	How we addressed it
“Set of criteria is fairly vague... I think choosing a more specific stakeholder group would help you to address specifics here more easily”	Made criteria more precise and related it to our main stakeholder group
“I don't really feel as if these solutions are presented as "necessary".”	Emphasized how the solutions would help the situation
(Solution 1) “No figure or table used for this solution. Maybe something about how widespread thinning is or its impacts would be beneficial.”	Added a figure from a study where thinning of lodgepole pine decreased the number of western gall rust infections
(Solution 1) “It also does not seem as fleshout as solution 2. I think you could explain the solution a little more and why it would be beneficial and work with your problem.”	Added a clearer description of the PCT process, a figure, more scientific studies to back up the pros and cons of the solution, and stakeholder benefits

(Solution 2) “Need to cite Fig. 3 and improve the caption. Also describe which tree species were in the experiment for context.”	Cited the figure and added a brief description of the experiment as well as tree species involved
(Solution 2) “I think that more detail could be used to describe the weaknesses of the solution.”	Weaknesses discussed
(Solution 2) “Stakeholder benefits are brief.”	Stakeholders discussed more in depth

Recommendations

Feedback	How we addressed it
“Section missing”	Added the section

Conclusion

Feedback	How we addressed it
“Section missing”	Added the section